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EDI 647

Professor Sarah Ada

The Power in a Poem

Lesson Title: The Power in a Poem

Grade Level: 11

Anticipated Duration of Lesson: 60 minutes

Minimum of 42-minute class period - but if it makes sense for your lesson to be longer - go for it! I really want this to work for you in your space with your students.

Overview

How does this lesson's activity relate to the larger unit? Where does this lesson fit into the grand scheme of things?

This lesson will continue to allow students to hear from various authors with multiple perspectives and backgrounds. During this unit, students will be reading poems from various living and some not living authors, gathering and recording their perspectives on issues such as identity, justice, and personal evolution/maturing.

For their final assessment, students will write their own poem that expresses their feelings on one of these issues.

During the following lesson, I will lead a class discussion where students will share their answers to the questions they encountered today.

Ideally, this unit will teach students that every voice has power and that power can be magnified through poetry.

NYS Standard Alignment:

[List of standards](#) that will be implemented in this lesson

Reading Standards:

11-12R4: Determine the meaning of words and phrases as they are used in a text,

including figurative and connotative meanings. Analyze the impact of specific word choices on meaning, tone, and mood, including words with multiple meanings. Analyze how an author uses and refines the meaning of technical or key term(s) over the course of a text.

11-12R5: In literary texts, analyze how varied aspects of structure create meaning and affect the reader. In informational texts, analyze the impact and evaluate the effect structure has on exposition or argument in terms of clarity, persuasive/rhetorical technique, and audience appeal.

Writing Standards:

11-12W5: Draw evidence from literary or informational texts to support analysis, reflection, and research. Apply the grade 11/12 Reading Standards to both literary and informational text, where applicable.

Speaking/Listening Standards:

11-12SL1: Initiate and participate effectively in a range of collaborative discussions with diverse partners on complex topics, texts, and issues; express ideas clearly and persuasively, and build on those of others.

11-12SL1c: Pose and respond to questions that probe reasoning and evidence; address a full range of positions; clarify, verify, or challenge ideas and conclusions; and promote divergent and creative perspectives.

11-12SL1d: Respond thoughtfully to diverse perspectives; synthesize comments, claims, and evidence made on all sides of an issue; resolve contradictions when possible; and determine what additional information or research is required to deepen the investigation or complete the task.

Lesson Objectives/Instructional Outcomes:

Outline the concept, knowledge, skill, or application students can demonstrate upon lesson completion. Objectives may be stated in the form of critical questions students should be able to answer.

Remember our focus on justice, inquiry, and action.

Students will be able to analyze and discuss poems to examine how authors use literary devices to express their perspectives on justice, identity, and social issues.

Today I will be able to analyze and discuss poems to examine how authors use literary devices to express their perspectives on justice, identity, and social issues.

Instructional Materials/Resources:

Provide links to all of the gathered/created materials and/or resources required by teacher and/or students during the lesson.

If some materials lack digital components (things such as textbooks, technology equipment, art materials, or equipment) you may just list them with any necessary clarifying information.

- Cromebooks
- Digital worksheet (Includes warm-up, station questions, and exit ticket)

Station 1

- “The Hill We Climb” poem (paper or digital)

<https://www.mitty.com/assets/files/asb/Amanda%20Gorman%20Inaguration%20Speech.pdf>

- “The Hill We Climb” video (linked in Google document)

<https://youtu.be/LZ055illiN4?si=D8QtTtwz7R9ql4a->

Station 2

- “What was I Made For?” song lyrics (paper or digital- on document)

<https://www.azlyrics.com/lyrics/billieeilish/whatwasimadefor.html>

- “What was I Made For?” video (linked in Google document)

<https://youtu.be/cW8VLC9nnTo?si=R8bZrNWhcp4IAy-m>

Station 3

- “What Now?” poem (paper or digital- on document)

<https://poets.org/poem/what-now>

- Headphones

Optional for on-paper annotating

- pens/pencils
- highlighters

The Plan in Action:

1. IntroductionAnticipatory Set: (7 minutes)

What first? How do we hook students?

- Daily check-in/settling in (3 minutes)

During this time, we will review the daily agenda and get out any needed materials for the day.

- Warm-up (5 minutes)

Students will conduct a free-write responding to the following prompt:

For the next 3 minutes, write continuously about justice, identity, and evolving as a person. This can be a personal connection, information you know about these topics, or something you would like to know about these topics.

2. Instructional Activities: Poetry stations (10-15 minutes each, 30-45 total)

Includes questioning techniques, grouping strategies, or other pedagogical approaches that align with the critical justice, inquiry, action framework

Students will rotate from station to station, independently or with a partner. Each person/pair will be assigned a starting station, then they will move between the stations set up around the room at their own pace.

- Station 1 (10-15 minutes)

Students will begin by reading/watching Amanda Gorman's speech "The Hill We Climb." Next, they will then re-read and annotate the text as they answer the following questions.

1. What is the author's message?
2. Highlight/underline and label 2 examples of alliteration
3. Highlight/underline and label 2 examples of repetition
4. How does the author's use of repetition and alliteration stress that part of the text?
5. What is the "hill we climb"?
6. How does it relate to justice?

- Station 2 (10-15 minutes)

Students will begin by reading/listening to the song “What Was I Made For” by Billie Eilish, and they will then re-read and annotate the text as they answer the following questions.

1. What is the author’s message?
2. Select at least 2 emojis to identify the mood of the song and explain in a complete sentence why you chose each one.
3. How does the music video complement your analysis of the lyrics? How does it differ?
4. How is identity seen in this poem?
5. Food for thought: How does this message relate to your own life? (You do not have to write an answer down if you don’t want to.)

- Station 3 (10-15 minutes)

Students will begin by reading “What Now?” by Gary Soto, and they will then re-read and annotate the text as they answer the following questions.

1. What is the author’s message?
2. What did the author mean by “And by my teens I no longer looked upward”?
3. . What is the tone of this poem?
4. How does this poem relate to maturing? Provide an example.

3. **Wrap-Up/Closure/Assessment** (Formal or Informal):

How do we know students “got it”?

- Exit ticket: to close out the lesson, students will answer questions on how each poem relates to one of the themes.

1. What does “The Hill We Climb” by Amanda Gorman say about justice?
2. What does the song “What Was I Made For” by Billie Eilish say about

identity?
3. What does the poem “What Now?” by Gary Soto say about maturing?

Differentiation According to Student Needs:

Address any differentiation considerations needed to support diverse student needs, including students with an IEP or 504, cultural or linguistic needs.

To accommodate students with IEPs and 504s, materials can be read, and they will have access to Text-to-speech and Speech-to-text technologies.

There are various modes in this lesson: videos, paper copies, and digital resources. Using various modes of resources caters to all students' learning preferences.

Students will have access to copies of each poem, both digitally and in paper copies.

Students will have the opportunity to work with a partner or independently.

I will be around, circulating the classroom, answering questions, and checking for understanding